
Sohinee Bera

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Sohinee Bera is a PhD Candidate in the Department of Communication at Cornell University. She is a critical communication scholar interested in how structural and cultural conditions shape health and environmental decisions and behaviors.

EDUCATION

- 2022 – Present **Cornell University**
PhD Candidate in Communication
Committee Chair: Bruce V. Lewenstein
Minor Members: Mohan J. Dutta, Katherine McComas, & Jeff Niederdeppe
- 2025 **Cornell University**
M.S. in Communication
- 2020 **Purdue University**
B.S. in Agricultural Communication
Thesis: The Sociology of Trust in Science: Evaluating and Predicting Levels of Scientism in Indiana Residents. *The Journal of Purdue Undergraduate Research*.
<https://doi.org/10.7771/2158-4052.1490>
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PUBLICATIONS

- Under revision **Bera, S.**, Gruber, A., Benevento, S., Li, C., Salazar De Leon, C., Moose, S. P., Bigman-Galimore, C., Lewenstein, B. *Who sees what* in programmable plants? Public imaginaries of emerging agriculture biotechnologies.
- April 2026 **Bera, S.**, Salazar De Leon, C., Lewenstein, B., Insights for Inclusive Upstream Engagement with Migrant Farmworkers in Agriculture: A case study from the US-Mexico border. *Ambio: A Journal of Environment and Society*.
- February 2026 Vilchez, A., **Bera, S.**, Lewenstein, B., Hilgartner, S., (2026). Examining media coverage of ethical dimensions of advanced algorithmic technology. *Public Understanding of Science*. doi.org/10.1177/09636625261419755
- January 2025 **Bera, S.**, Vilchez, A., Muenster, R. (2025). Environmental issues are a global issue -but do environmental communication journals reflect this? A publication review of environmental communication scholarship. *Frontiers in Communication*.
doi.org/10.3389/fcomm.2024.1474619
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CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- May 2026 **Bera, S.**, When Health Work Becomes Data Work: The (In)Visibility of Community Health Workers in Rural India. *International Communication Association*. Capetown, South Africa.
- May 2026 **Bera, S.**, Gruber, A., Benevento, S., Li, C., Salazar De Leon, C., Moose, S. P., Bigman-Galimore, C., Lewenstein, B. *Who sees what* in programmable plants? Public imaginaries of emerging agriculture biotechnologies. *International Communication Association*. Capetown, South Africa.
- November 2025 **Bera, S.**, Gruber, A., Salazar de Leon, C. When Slow Foods Meet Fast Technologies. *National Communication Association*. Denver, Colorado
- May 2025 **Bera, S.** Inclusive Public Engagement with U.S. Migrant Farmworkers: Criteria and Challenges. *Public Communication of Science and Technology Network*. Aberdeen, Scotland.

December 2024	Bera, S., Salazar De Leon, C., Voices from the Fields: Migrant Farmworker’s Perspectives on Emerging Plant Biotechnologies and Insights for Engaging Hard-to-Reach Populations. <i>Society for Risk Analysis</i> . Austin, Texas.
September 2024	Gruber, A., Bera, S., Salazar De Leon., C. (2024, September). Programmable Plants for a Sustainable Future. <i>Slow Foods: Terra Madre</i> . Turin, Italy.
April 2024	Bera, S. “You can lead a horse to water, but you can't make him drink”: the unheard sanitation discourses of the Swachh Bharat Mission in India. <i>Public Communication of Science and Technology Network</i> , Zacatecas, Mexico.
May 2023	Bera, S., Vilchez, A., Muenster, R., Environmental issues are global issues – but do environmental communication journals reflect this? A publication review. <i>International Communication Association</i> , Toronto, Canada.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Summer 2023 & 2025	COMM 2850: Communication, Environment, Science, and Health <i>Instructor of Record</i>
Spring 2023	COMM 2850: Communication, Environment, Science, and Health <i>Teaching Assistant</i>
Fall 2022 & Fall 2025	COMM 2450: Communication and Technology <i>Teaching Assistant</i>

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, & HONORS

Spring 2026	SUNY Provost’s Diversity Fellowship
Spring 2026	U.S. Department of Education & Cornell’s South Asia Program: FLAS Fellowship (<i>awarded, declined</i>)
Fall 2025	CSSS Qualitative and Interpretive Research Institute Small Research Grant
Fall 2025	Waterhouse Family Institute Research Grant
Spring 2025	Community Access and Outreach Award for Impact on Communities Beyond Cornell for GRASSHOPR
Summer 2024	Visiting Scholar at Joshua Tree National Park
2022	Cornell Fellowship
2022	Cornell Graduate School Dean’s Scholars
2021- 2022	U.S. Fulbright Grantee, English Teaching Assistant in Germany

MENTORSHIP & ENGAGEMENT

May – August 2026	Supervised and trained undergraduate research assistant in transcription of Bengali-language interviews, including instruction in IRB compliance, research ethics, and qualitative methods. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
June 2025	Co-led science communication workshop with visiting REU students. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
July 2024 – August 2024	Developed “Introduction to Social Science” crash course for visiting REU students. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
July 2024	Co-led science communication workshops with visiting REU students & CURIE Academy high school students. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
June 2024 – August 2024	Mentored REU student and supervised research on public perceptions of genetically modified organisms. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY.

MEDIA COVERAGE

October 2025	Research featured in exhibit “Hello, Human! The Emerging Science of Plant Communication and Smart Agriculture.” Mann Gallery, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
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March 2025	Quoted in the <i>Cornell Chronicle</i> article " From Lab to Learning: Grad Students Bring Hands-On Science to NYS Classrooms "
January 2025	Quoted in the <i>Cornell Chronicle</i> article " Communicating with CROPPS Research in Arizona "
January 2025	Interviewed for a segment on engaging migrant farmworkers for <i>Science IRL</i> video. " How a Giant Robot & Red Light Can Save Plants from Climate Change ."

INVITED TALKS

May 2025	Invited Talk on "Growing Responsibly: Internal and External Visions of Emerging Plant Biotechnologies" for CROPPS NSF Site Visit. Cornell University. Ithaca, NY.
March 2024	Invited Talk on "Embedded Social Science in Public Engagement Case study" to CROPPS Scientific and Industrial Advisory Board. Online.
October 2023	Presentation on "Public Engagement Criteria and Evaluation" at CROPPS annual meeting at University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign, IL
March 2023	Guest lecture on "Negotiations of India's Swachh Bharat Mission" for COMM 2850 (Communication Science, Health, and Environment). Cornell University, Ithaca, NY

SERVICE & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

2022 – 2026 Graduate Student School Outreach Program (GRASSHOPR)

- Fellow (2022-24), Treasurer (2023-24), Vice President (2024-2026)
- Facilitated course development and applications from graduate students, successfully matched with local teachers to ensure over 90 meaningful teaching lesson experiences
- Developed two-week course for local elementary students on ecological ways of knowing and discovering nature and art in everyday life

2023-2024 Communication Graduate Student Association (Vice President)

- Secured \$1,500 in additional external funding for graduate student programming
- Organized and led professional development workshops and social events to support graduate student community
- Helped serve as student liaison to department chair and director of graduate studies, representing graduate student interests and concerns

2020 Guide to Black Lafayette

- Created an online directory of Black-owned businesses and services in the Greater Lafayette, IN area to help support Black Livelihoods
- Designed all composition, color, illustration, branding, PR, and media
- Received over 6,000 visits on the site within a three-week time period

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021-2022 U.S. Fulbright Grantee

English Teaching, Geschwister-Scholl Realschule Plus, Andernach, Germany

- Supported English instruction in 12 classes a week from grades 5-10
- Developed culturally relevant and engaging lessons on topics related to American culture, current events, history, holidays, and English grammar
- Fostered community and inclusion as a Diversity Placement at a school with significant population of refugee and immigrant students

2021 **Visitor Damage Mitigation Intern**

Joshua Tree National Park, CA

- Mapped, monitored, and restored illegal off-highway vehicle incursions, graffiti, and other instances of visitor damage to sensitive desert ecological and cultural resources to protect and preserve the park
- Developed a mitigation plan on visitor impacts to best concentrate restoration efforts, ensure future sustainable recreation, and address future impacts of climate change

2020 **Organic Agriculture Extension Research Assistant**

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

- Assisted with transcribing farmer case study interviews, qualitative data entry, qualitative data analysis, and report writing
- Facilitated and advised organic advisory groups as well as planned, promoted, and hosted research field days
- Created interactive graphics and visualizations and re-designed program website

2019 **Culture-Centered Approach for Research and Evaluation (CARE) Research Intern**

Massey University, Palmerston North, New Zealand

Advised by Dr. Mohan J, Dutta

- Conducted semi-structured interviews investigating how immigrants and refugees to New Zealand construct and negotiate their experiences of racism within the context of health and wellbeing

SKILLS

Software	R, Adobe Photoshop, Premiere Pro, Illustrator
Languages	English (native), Bengali (native), German (proficient)
